

digital-currency ecosystem and the ways to evaluate risk and invest wisely within that ecosystem. They should familiarize themselves with the financial and tax implications, as well as the legal and regulatory issues—all of which are developing daily.”⁴⁰

Currently, GBTC is available for typical investors through brokerage firms. With an online and self-directed investment account, investors should be able to get a quote on GBTC and buy the asset for their accounts.

For investors with an advisor at a wealth management firm, placing the order for GBTC may require interfacing with your advisor so the firm can make the purchase. It won’t be uncommon to get some pushback due to a lack of awareness related to this investment vehicle from financial advisors, whether they’re independent or from a wirehouse. At this point, innovative investors should recognize that bitcoin and other cryptoassets can have a positive impact on their investment portfolios. Financial advisors and investment firms would be well served to be knowledgeable, informed, and open to discuss these investment vehicles appropriately with clients.

Fortunately, the financial services industry is warming to these investments and the need to bring advisors up to speed. In 2014, the Financial Planning Association (FPA) produced a report clearly detailing its take on the matter titled, “The Value of Bitcoin in Enhancing the Efficiency of an Investor’s Portfolio.”⁴¹ The FPA supports financial advisors and others associated with the Certified Financial Planner™ (CFP™)